

1. Six Minute English from bbclearningenglish.com

来自**bbclearningenglish.com**的“六分钟英语”节目

2. Hello, this is 6 Minute English from BBC Learning English.

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3. I'm Pippa.

我叫皮帕。

4. And I'm Beth.

而我叫贝丝。

5. In English, what we say and what we mean are sometimes two very different things.

在英语中，我们所说的话和我们真正想表达的意思有时是两回事。

6. We often use exaggeration for emphasis or for humour, something known as hyperbole.

我们常常使用夸张的手法来强调某些内容或营造幽默效果，这种表达方式就被称为夸张法。

7. For example, people say, I am so hungry I could eat a horse, but of course no one really could.

例如，人们会说“我饿极了，甚至能吃下一匹马”，但当然实际上没有人真的能做到这一点。

8. Here's presenter Michael Rosen and linguist Derek Bousfield discussing one example of hyperbole on BBC Radio 4's Word of Mouth.

在BBC Radio 4的《口口相传》节目中，主持人迈克尔·罗森与语言学家德里克·布斯菲尔德共同探讨了一个夸张修辞的例子。

9. People do say absolute nightmare.

人们确实说这简直是一场噩梦。

10. Or as my daughters would say, I've had a mare today.

用我女儿们的话来说，今天我可真是“交好运”了。

11. And when they say mare, which is obviously shortened for nightmare, what it basically means is they've had a mild and potentially slightly humorous occurrence at work.

而当他们说“mare”时，这显然是“nightmare”的缩写，其实指的是他们在工作中遇到了一些轻微的、甚至有点滑稽的事情。

12. You might call an unpleasant or difficult experience a nightmare.

你可以将那些不愉快或艰难的经历称为噩梦。

13. Derek's daughter used the word mare, short for nightmare, to describe her terrible day at work.

德里克的女儿用“mare”这个词——也就是“噩梦”的缩写——来形容她在工作中度过的

糟糕一天。

14. But she was exaggerating.

但她是在夸大其词。

15. Her day wasn't really terrible, more like strange or annoying.

她这一天其实并不算太糟糕，只不过有些奇怪，或者让人感到有些恼人罢了。

16. Can you remember a time when what you said wasn't really what you meant, Beth?

贝丝，你还记得有那么一次，你说的话其实并不是你真正的想法吗？

17. Well, sometimes we say, hi, are you all right?

有时候，我们会问：“喂，你没事吧？”

18. Which means, hi, are you all right?

也就是说，嗨，你没事吧？

19. Like, are you okay?

你没事吧？

20. But actually, we don't really want to hear the answer.

但实际上，我们并不真的想听到这个答案。

21. It just means hello, doesn't it?

它只不过是用来表示“你好”的意思，不是吗？

22. Yeah, I have a friend who actually just says, all right?

是的，我有一个朋友，他总是就说“好吧”而已。

23. And they just mean, hello.

它们只不过是用来表示“你好”而已。

24. They don't mean, are you okay?

他们并不是在问你是否没事。

25. They don't want to hear about my day.

他们根本不想听我讲今天发生了什么。

26. No, if you're having a bad day, they don't want to know.

不，如果你今天过得不顺，他们并不想知道。

27. They're just saying hello.

他们只是在打招呼而已。

28. In this episode, we'll be finding out more about how the meaning of words changes in English.

在这一集中，我们将进一步了解英语中单词的含义是如何发生变化的。

29. As usual, we'll be learning some useful new words and phrases.

像往常一样，我们将学习一些有用的新单词和短语。

30. And remember, you'll find all the vocabulary from this episode on our website, bbclearningenglish.com.

请记住，这一集中出现的所有词汇都可以在我们的网站**bbclearningenglish.com**上找到。

31. But first, I have a question for you, Beth.

但首先，我有个问题要问你，贝丝。

32. The word hyperbole comes from two ancient Greek words, hupa and ballo.

“夸张”这个词来源于两个古希腊词汇：hupa和ballo。

33. But what is their literal meaning?

但它们的字面意思是什么呢？

34. Is it A, to overthrow, B, to overspeak, or C, to overthink?

是A、推翻现有秩序，还是B、言过其实，又或者是C、过度思考呢？

35. I have no idea, Pippa.

我完全不知道，皮帕。

36. I'm going to say to over-speak.

我打算说，有些人说话实在太过分了。

37. OK, we'll find out the answer at the end of the programme.

好的，我们会在节目结束时找到答案。

38. It's not just hyperbole that changes the meaning of words.

并非只有夸张手法才会改变词语的含义。

39. Its opposite, something called understatement, has the same effect too.

其相反的情况，也就是所谓的轻描淡写，也会产生同样的效果。

40. Understatement involves de-emphasising something.

轻描淡写意味着淡化某事物的重要性。

41. For example, imagine you were served an awful meal in a restaurant, but instead of saying how bad the food was, you just said it was less than perfect.

例如，想象一下你在餐厅吃了一顿非常难吃的饭菜，但你没有直接说食物有多难吃，而只是说它还不够完美。

42. Here's linguist Derek Bowsfield discussing understatement on BBC Radio 4's Word of Mouth.

以下是语言学家德里克·鲍斯菲尔德在BBC Radio 4的《口口相传》节目中谈论轻描淡写这一表达方式的内容。

43. We love understatement as a way of kind of signalling that something much more serious has gone on.

我们喜欢用轻描淡写的方式来暗示其实发生了某些更为严重的事情。

44. And it's a kind of performative, sardonic, not taking oneself too seriously identity when you do that.

而且，在这样做的时候，其实体现的是一种表演性的、带有讽刺意味的身份认同方式，也就是不会太把自己当回事。

45. Because, you know, taking yourself too seriously is a no-no in British culture. 因为你知道，在英国文化中，把自己太当回事是绝对不可取的。

46. And so linguistically not taking yourself too seriously is really the done thing. 因此，从语言学的角度来看，不要过于认真地对待自己，这才是正确的做法。

47. Understatement is valued in British culture, unlike taking yourself too seriously. 在英国文化中，低调行事是一种被看重的品质，而过于认真对待自己则不被推崇。

48. If you take yourself too seriously, you think you're more important than you really are.

如果你把自己看得太重要了，你就会认为自己比实际更重要。

49. In Britain, this is a no-no, a way of behaving that is not socially acceptable. 在英国，这种行为是绝对不可接受的，属于不被社会所认可的行为方式。

50. In other words, it's not the done thing, meaning it's not what you're expected to do in a particular social situation.

换句话说，这种行为并不符合社会规范，也就是说，在特定的社交场合中，人们并不期望你这样做。

51. Another area where the meaning of words can be easily misunderstood is apologising.

另一个词语含义容易被误解的领域就是道歉这一行为。

52. Here, Michael Rosen responds to an imaginary situation where his toe gets accidentally stepped on by Derek Bousfield for BBC Radio 4 programme Word of Mouth.

在这里，迈克尔·罗森针对一种虚构的情形进行了回应——在BBC第四电台的节目《口口相传》中，德里克·布斯菲尔德不小心踩到了他的脚趾。

53. imagine uh i stepped on your toe and i said oh michael i'm really sorry and you said it's all good oh right that probably means it isn't yes i'm actually a bit miffed a little bit annoyed but then i don't want to have a barney with you you're a stranger so i don't want to get into a whole thing so i say yeah it's all good it's all good exactly it's a bit like yeah i mean that's a british english one an equivalent american english one would be no worries

想象一下，如果我踩到了你的脚趾，然后我说“哦，迈克尔，我真的非常抱歉”，而你回答说“没关系，哦，对，那大概意味着其实并没有什么大问题”。不过说实话，我其实还有点生气，有点恼火，但既然你是陌生人，我又不想和你闹翻，所以就只好说“嗯，没关系，确实没什么大问题”。这种表达在英式英语中很常见，而在美式英语中，人们可能会说“No

worries” 。

54. If someone tells you it's all good, they could actually be feeling miffed, an adjective meaning slightly annoyed or hurt by someone's behaviour.

如果有人对你说一切都没问题，其实他们可能心里正在恼火——“恼火”这个形容词用来形容因某人的行为而感到略微生气或受伤。

55. But no matter how annoyed you are, you probably don't want to get into a barney, a loud argument or quarrel.

但无论有多恼火，你大概都不想陷入激烈的争吵或大声的争执之中吧。

56. So you say something like it's all good or no worries and move on.

所以你就说“没关系的”或者“别担心”，然后继续做你的事。

57. As an English learner, unclear word meanings are a challenge.

作为英语学习者来说，那些含义不明确的单词确实是个难题。

58. A lot depends on the situation and on the relationship between speaker and listener.

这在很大程度上取决于具体的情境以及说话者与听者之间的关系。

59. So don't be shy, get talking to others in English.

所以别害羞，大胆用英语和别人交流吧。

60. And if you make a mistake, say no worries and carry on.

而且如果你犯了错误，也别担心，继续前进就好。

61. Okay, Pippa, I think it's time to reveal the answer to your question.

好的，皮帕，我觉得现在是时候揭晓你这个问题的答案了。

62. Yes, you thought the ancient Greek words huper and ballo meant overspeak, but the answer was actually A, to overthrow.

是的，你可能以为古希腊语中的“huper”和“ballo”意味着“说得过多”，但实际上它们的含义是“A”，即“推翻”。

63. Huper means beyond and ballo means I throw.

“Huper”意味着“超越”，而“ballo”则意味着“我投掷”。

64. Oh well.

Oh well.

65. OK, let's recap the vocabulary we've learnt, starting with mare, short for nightmare, meaning an unpleasant or difficult experience.

好的，让我们回顾一下我们学过的词汇。首先是从“mare”这个词开始，它是“nightmare”的缩写，意思是令人不愉快或难以应对的经历。

66. If you take yourself too seriously, you consider yourself and your actions more important than they really are.

如果你过于把自己当回事，就会认为自己和自己的行为比实际更重要。

67. In Britain, this is a no-no, a way of behaving that is not socially acceptable.
在英国，这种行为是绝对不可接受的，属于不被社会所认可的行为方式。

68. The done thing, on the other hand, is what you are expected to do in a particular social situation.

另一方面，所谓“应该做的事情”，是指在特定的社交场合中人们期望你去做的那些事情。

69. If you're miffed, you're slightly annoyed by someone's behaviour.

如果你感到恼火，那就意味着某人的行为让你有点生气。

70. And finally, a barney is a loud argument or quarrel.

最后，“barney”指的是一场激烈的争吵或口角。

71. Once again, our six minutes are up, but if you're keen to practise these new words and phrases, then check out our website, bbclearningenglish.com, where you'll find a worksheet and quiz for this episode.

再次提醒，我们的六分钟时间已经到了，但如果您还想继续练习这些新单词和短语，欢迎访问我们的网站**bbclearningenglish.com**，在那里您可以找到与这一集内容相关的练习表格和测验。

72. See you again soon, but for now, goodbye!

再见吧，很快就会再见面，但现在，先告辞了！

73. Bye!

再见！

74. Six Minute English from bbclearningenglish.com

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